

Product Requirements Document

1. Project Overview

The platform connects three types of users - **individual job seekers, employers, and educational institutions** - around a candidate-quality signal that is generated primarily from a candidate's resume/CV. Employers pay to search and contact candidates who meet a quality threshold. Educational institutions get visibility into their students' outcomes on the platform. An internal admin team manages trust, verification, and disputes across all sides.

The product targets users primarily in India, so localization (6-8 vernacular support), UPI-based payments, and India-specific business verification (e.g., GSTIN-style checks) are in scope. This is not a lending, credit-scoring, or financial-services product - no financial credit terminology should be used anywhere in the product.

1.1 The four application surfaces

Surface	Users	Platform
Candidate / Student Application	Job seekers	Mobile Application (Android + iOS) (responsive, phone-first)
Employer Console	Hiring businesses (primarily small/medium businesses)	Desktop web
Institution Console	Colleges/training institutes	Desktop web
Admin Console	Internal operations team	Desktop web

All five surfaces are powered by one shared backend - there is a single set of APIs; the agency should not design or scope separate backend systems per surface.

2. Objectives

- Give a job seeker a credible, explainable quality score derived from their resume, at no cost, before any payment is required.
- Let employers filter a candidate pool by that score and pay only to unlock contact details of candidates they're interested in.

- Let educational institutions see aggregate outcomes for their enrolled students without exposing individual student data without consent.
 - Give internal staff tools to verify businesses, catch abuse/fraud, and resolve disputes.
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3. Non-negotiable product rules

These rules should be treated as hard constraints during build, not just guidelines:

1. **The core candidate score must be explainable and reproducible** - it should always be possible to show a user which factors contributed to their score, and by how much. For display purposes, any score calculated below 680 out of 999 must be shown as a minimum of 680, while scores of 680 and above should reflect their original calculated values. The exact scoring algorithm and weighting is proprietary and will be provided as a separate specification to the assigned engineering team under NDA; for initial scoping, assume a modular "resume scoring engine" service that takes structured resume data as input and returns a numeric score plus a breakdown by category.
2. **The score is never directly editable by any human**, including internal admin staff. If a correction is needed, staff can only correct the underlying resume data, which triggers an automatic recalculation. There is no "manually override the score" feature anywhere in the product.
3. **Optional paid add-ons (see below) must never change the core score.** A user completing a paid assessment or interview product should see their core score remain mathematically identical before and after — this needs to be verifiable, not just visually true.
4. **No age-gating.** The product must not require or gate functionality on a user's age or date of birth. Do not implement an 18+ requirement anywhere in the flow, even as a seemingly reasonable default.
5. **No financial/lending framing.** Do not use terms like "credit score," "loan eligibility," or similar in any user-facing copy, variable names, or documentation, even internally — this is a legal requirement, not a style preference.
6. **Employers cannot see a candidate's contact details, exact score, or sensitive personal data until they explicitly "unlock" that candidate**, which is a billed, audited action. Search results for employers must be presented as anonymized/masked data (score band or range, general location, skills - not name, phone, or email).
7. **Employers cannot post live job listings until their business has passed a verification step (KYB).**
8. **Institutions cannot see individual student data without that student's explicit consent**, given via an invite-and-accept flow. Institutions only ever see aggregate/cohort-level statistics unless a student has separately consented to individual visibility.
9. Every action that reveals private data (an employer unlocking a candidate, an admin accessing a user's full record) must be logged in an audit trail: who, what, when.

4. Surface 1 — Candidate / Student Application (Mobile Application)

4.1 Onboarding & Account Creation

- Sign-up/login via **phone number (OTP-based)**, with **Google sign-in** and **email** as alternative options.
- No account is required to try the core scoring flow — a user should be able to reach their first score before being asked to create an account (account creation happens after they've seen value, not before).
- Language selection between English and Hindi, switchable at any time.

4.2 Resume Intake, Processing & Scoring

- User uploads a resume file (PDF/DOC) or pastes text, or manually fills a structured form.
- System parses the uploaded file into structured fields (name, education history, skills, projects, work experience).
- User reviews and edits the parsed data before confirming — parsing will not be 100% accurate, so an editable review step is mandatory, not optional.
- On confirmation, the system computes a candidate score (see Section 3, rule 1) and displays:
 - An overall numeric score
 - A category-by-category breakdown
 - The top few specific suggestions for improving the score
- Users should be able to generate a shareable result card. By default, this card should show a score *tier/band* (e.g., "Strong") rather than the exact number, with an explicit opt-in toggle if the user wants to display the exact number publicly.

4.3 Attribute Questionnaire (Add-on)

- An optional questionnaire covering various personal/professional attributes (work style, interests, role preferences) producing a supplementary profile report.
- This is a **sibling signal, not a scoring input** — completing it must not change the core resume-derived score (see Section 3, rule 3).

4.4 AI Mock Interview (Paid Add-on)

- A **paid**, phone-based interview simulation: the user answers interview questions by recording responses (audio/video) directly on their phone.

- Before payment, run a device/environment check (camera, microphone, lighting, network, storage) so the user doesn't pay and then fail to complete the session due to a technical issue.
- Answers should upload progressively (per-question), not as one large file at the end, so a dropped connection mid-session doesn't lose earlier answers.
- After processing (which may involve third-party speech-to-text and language-model based evaluation — vendor to be confirmed separately), the user receives a rubric-style result report.
- Like the questionnaire, this must never change the core score.

4.5 Job Discovery & Applications

- Browse/search available job listings, with filters (role, location, etc.).
 - Each listing shows whether the user's current score meets that employer's minimum threshold, and if not, what would need to improve.
 - Apply to a listing; view and withdraw applications.
 - An "Application Board" showing status per application through defined stages (e.g., submitted → viewed → shortlisted → interview → hired/rejected), with automatic expiry if an employer goes silent for a defined period.
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5. Surface 2 — Employer Console (Desktop Web)

5.1 Onboarding & Business Verification (KYB)

- Account creation with password + two-factor authentication (authenticator app / TOTP).
- Business verification flow: employer submits registration/tax documents; status moves through pending → under review → approved/rejected.
- **Hard gate: no job listing can be published (made live/visible to candidates) until KYB is approved.** This should be enforced server-side, not just hidden in the UI.
- Support for multiple team members per employer account with basic roles (e.g., owner, recruiter, view-only).

5.2 Job Management

- **Job Composer:** create a listing with structured fields — title, description, required skills, **salary range (mandatory field)**, and a minimum score threshold. While setting the threshold, show a live count of how many current candidates in the pool meet that bar (count only — never a preview list of actual candidates or their data).
- **Publish:** listing goes live only if KYB is approved.
- **Incoming Applications:** view candidates who applied to a specific listing.
- **Multiple Stages:** move an applicant through a fixed set of pipeline stages (not a fully customizable pipeline — a small fixed set, e.g., 5 stages, is sufficient for this build).

- **Scheduling Meetings:** employer attaches their own external meeting link (e.g., a calendar/video-call link they generate elsewhere) to an applicant at a given stage — the platform does not need to build in-house video calling.
- **Hire Confirmation:** mark a candidate as hired; ideally requires confirmation from both employer and candidate sides before being treated as a final/billable hire event.

5.3 Candidate Discovery

- **Search:** browse/filter the candidate pool by score band, location, skills, and completed add-ons (badges only — no raw content). Results must be masked/anonymized — no name, phone, email, or exact score visible pre-unlock.
 - **Unlock:** a billed action that reveals a specific candidate's contact details and exact score. Before the action completes, show the cost and remaining quota/balance. Every unlock must write an auditable record (who unlocked, when, which candidate, cost).
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6. Surface 3 — Institution Console (Desktop Web)

6.1 Onboarding & Roster Management

- Account creation with basic authentication (password + 2FA recommended).
- **Bulk Upload Students:** institution staff upload a list of student contacts (phone/email) to invite them to link their existing candidate account to the institution's roster.
- Students must explicitly accept the invite/consent before any of their data becomes visible to the institution — this cannot be bypassed by the institution.

6.2 Student Overview Analytics

- Aggregate, cohort-level statistics only (e.g., score distribution across the linked student roster, median score) — no individual student data should be exposed through this view unless a student has separately granted individual-level visibility consent.

6.3 Placement Tracking

- Visibility into hiring outcomes that occurred through the platform for students on the institution's roster, clearly labeled as "platform-sourced outcomes" (not implying credit for offers/placements that happened outside the platform).
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7. Surface 4 — Admin Console (Desktop Web, Internal Use Only)

7.1 KYB Queue

- Queue of pending employer verification submissions; reviewers can approve, reject (with a reason), or request more information.

7.2 Resume Flagged / Integrity Queue

- A queue of resumes/accounts flagged by automated integrity checks (e.g., suspected duplicate/templated submissions across multiple accounts, internally inconsistent timelines).
- Reviewers can clear a flag (restoring visibility to employers) or confirm a violation (which may suspend the account or keep the profile hidden from employer search).
- High-severity flags should automatically withhold a profile from employer search *before* human review, not after.

7.3 Users (Candidate List)

- Searchable list of all candidate accounts, with drill-down into full profile data, score history, application history, and flags for a given user — restricted to authorized admin roles.

7.4 Employers List

- Searchable list of employer accounts, with drill-down into KYB status, job listings, billing/unlock history, and team members.

7.5 Institutions List

- Searchable list of institution accounts, with drill-down into roster size, linked students, and usage.

7.6 Dispute Queue

- A unified queue of support tickets/disputes raised by candidates, employers, or institutions, with the ability to investigate and resolve, cross-linking to the Integrity Queue or a specific user/employer record where relevant.

8. Non-functional requirements

Area

Requirement

Localization	Full UI in English and 6-8 vernacular languages at launch; no hardcoded user-facing strings — all copy sourced from resource/locale files
Authentication	OTP-based phone auth for candidates; password + 2FA (TOTP) for all business/admin consoles
Data isolation	Strict tenant isolation — one employer or institution must never be able to query or infer another's data through any endpoint
Auditability	Every action that reveals private/personal data must be logged with actor, timestamp, and target
Privacy	Users must be able to request export or deletion of their data; requests should be trackable with a due date
Performance	Core scoring flow should feel near-instant to the end user even if compute happens asynchronously behind a loading state
Device targets	Candidate app must perform acceptably on low-end Android devices and slower mobile networks — this is a primary user segment, not an edge case
Payments	UPI-first payment flow for the paid mock interview product; entitlements must only be granted after a verified/signed payment confirmation from the payment provider, never from a client-side callback alone

9. Explicitly out of scope for this build

- Fully configurable/custom hiring pipelines (a fixed small set of stages is sufficient)
 - Built-in video calling (employers use their own external meeting links)
 - Social feed / follow / public profile browsing features
 - Payroll, formal offer-letter generation, or background-verification services
 - Any lending, credit-scoring, or financial-product functionality
 - Any outcome/hiring guarantee marketing claims
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10. What will be provided separately (not included in this document)

The following will only be shared with the selected agency after contracts/NDA are finalized:

- Final brand identity, visual design system, and UI design files

- The exact scoring algorithm, dimension weights, and integrity-detection rules
 - Production API contracts and data schemas
 - Names of third-party vendors (payment gateway, business-verification provider, SMS/OTP provider, AI/voice processing provider)
 - Legal/compliance review documentation
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11. Deliverables expected from the agency (for scoping purposes)

- Technical architecture proposal (tech stack recommendation, infrastructure plan)
 - Detailed effort/timeline estimate broken down by the four surfaces above
 - Team composition and staffing plan
 - QA/testing approach
 - Post-launch support/maintenance proposal
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This document is provided for scoping and estimation purposes only and does not constitute a full technical specification. A detailed specification, design system, and API contract will be shared with the selected partner under a signed confidentiality agreement.